

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 19)

Page 92 - Robert Herrick and the Cavalier Poets

Q1. Under what title was Robert Herrick's religious poetry published?

- A. Hesperides
- B. Noble Numbers
- C. The Temple
- D. Religious Emblems

Answer: B

Q2. Under what title was Robert Herrick's secular poetry published?

- A. Hesperides
- B. Noble Numbers
- C. The Alchemist
- D. Amoretti

Answer: A

Q3. What is a singular historical feature of Herrick's delightful, spontaneous secular poetry?

- A. It was entirely written in Latin
- B. Its complete detachment from the political interests of the hour (aloof from the tumult)
- C. It heavily criticized the King
- D. It was the only poetry allowed by the Puritans

Answer: B

Q4. What is the name of the group of Caroline poets whose inspiration was entirely or almost entirely secular?

- A. The Puritan Poets
- B. The Metaphysical Poets
- C. The 'Cavalier' group
- D. The University Wits

Answer: C

Q5. Which three principal names belong to the Cavalier group?

- A. Milton, Donne, Jonson

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- B. Carew, Suckling, Lovelace
- C. Herbert, Crashaw, Vaughan
- D. Marlowe, Kyd, Lyly

Answer: B

Q6. How did the Cavalier poets treat their art?

- A. They took it extremely seriously
- B. They wrote in a lighter vein and made no pretence at treating their art seriously
- C. They only wrote religious epics
- D. They refused to publish their work

Answer: B

Q7. Who wrote 'To Althea from Prison'?

- A. Thomas Carew
- B. Sir John Suckling
- C. Richard Lovelace
- D. Andrew Marvell

Answer: C

Q8. Why is Andrew Marvell joined with the Cavalier poets despite his later political stances?

- A. He was the King's brother
- B. His earlier work exhibits many of the characteristics of the Cavalier school
- C. He only wrote love poems
- D. He never wrote about politics

Answer: B

Q9. Who is the most widely known of the Caroline poets who found their main interest in religion, author of 'The Temple'?

- A. Richard Crashaw
- B. Henry Vaughan
- C. George Herbert
- D. Francis Quarles

Answer: C

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Q10. Whose sacred verse, though unequal and ruined by conceits at times, has far greater fire and passion than Herbert's?

- A. Francis Quarles
- B. Richard Crashaw
- C. Henry Vaughan
- D. Robert Herrick

Answer: B

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Page 93 - The Metaphysical Poets

Q1. Who is usually regarded as the chief representative of the 'metaphysical' school of poetry?

- A. Abraham Cowley
- B. John Milton
- C. George Herbert
- D. Thomas Carew

Answer: A

Q2. Which later critic first applied the name 'metaphysical' to this school of poetry?

- A. Matthew Arnold
- B. Samuel Johnson
- C. Charles Lamb
- D. John Dryden

Answer: B

Q3. According to Johnson, what was the whole endeavor of the metaphysical poets?

- A. To write beautiful music
- B. To copy nature and life
- C. To show their learning
- D. To inspire religious devotion

Answer: C

Q4. How does Johnson describe the thoughts of the metaphysical poets?

- A. Obvious and just
- B. Often new, but seldom natural; neither obvious nor just
- C. Completely plagiarized from the Greeks
- D. Entirely focused on politics

Answer: B

Q5. Which of the following is NOT a salient feature of the metaphysical group of writers?

- A. Work packed with affectations and conceits
- B. Clear, simple, and emotionally natural language

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- C. Strained metaphors and extravagant hyperbole
- D. Substitution of philosophical subtleties for natural expression of feeling

Answer: B

Q6. As a result of their effort to surprise by novelty and ingenuity at any cost, how is their work generally described?

- A. Smooth, calm, and soothing
- B. Violent, harsh, cold, and obscure
- C. Hilariously funny
- D. Incredibly brief

Answer: B

Q7. Does the author believe the metaphysical poets completely lacked genius?

- A. Yes, they had no talent at all
- B. No, they occasionally give passages or poems of real power and beauty despite their vicious theories
- C. Yes, they were just pretending to be poets
- D. No, they are considered greater than Shakespeare

Answer: B

Q8. What frantic absurdity does the text use as an example from Crashaw regarding Mary Magdalene's eyes?

- A. He called them 'stars of the night'
- B. He called them 'two walking baths, two weeping motions, portable and compendious oceans'
- C. He called them 'mirrors of the soul'
- D. He called them 'black holes'

Answer: B

Q9. Why did English poetry go astray during this time, according to Johnson?

- A. By voluntary deviation from nature in pursuit of something new and strange
- B. Because of the Puritan ban on theaters
- C. Because no one knew how to read
- D. Because they were copying French styles exclusively

Answer: A

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Q10. Who produced the last important works of the metaphysical school, later discarding much of the extravagance?

- A. Richard Crashaw
- B. Abraham Cowley
- C. Thomas Traherne
- D. George Herbert

Answer: B

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Page 94 - Traherne and Caroline Prose (Part 1)

Q1. Which slightly younger writer's manuscripts were lost to sight for nearly two hundred years after his death?

- A. Thomas Traherne
- B. Abraham Cowley
- C. Jeremy Taylor
- D. Izaak Walton

Answer: A

Q2. When were Thomas Traherne's 'Poems' finally published?

- A. 1704
- B. 1850
- C. 1903
- D. 2000

Answer: C

Q3. Besides being a great religious/metaphysical poet, what did Traherne's 'Centuries of Meditations' (1908) show?

- A. That he was a great playwright
- B. That he was a great prose writer also
- C. That he was a scientist
- D. That he was actually a woman

Answer: B

Q4. Which eloquent divine wrote the acknowledged religious prose classics 'Holy Living' and 'Holy Dying'?

- A. Richard Baxter
- B. Thomas Fuller
- C. Jeremy Taylor
- D. Sir Thomas Browne

Answer: C

Q5. Which Puritan wrote the classic 'The Saints' Everlasting Rest'?

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- A. Richard Baxter
- B. Jeremy Taylor
- C. John Milton
- D. Francis Bacon

Answer: A

Q6. Which quaint, witty, and vivacious divine is best remembered today for his delightful miscellaneous 'Worthies of England'?

- A. Jeremy Taylor
- B. Thomas Fuller
- C. Thomas Hobbes
- D. Edward Hyde

Answer: B

Q7. What was the profession of Sir Thomas Browne, author of books full of varied and curious erudition?

- A. A physician
- B. A lawyer
- C. A priest
- D. An actor

Answer: A

Q8. What is Sir Thomas Browne's main title to fame (his personal confession of religious faith)?

- A. The Saints' Everlasting Rest
- B. Religio Medici
- C. The Compleat Angler
- D. Leviathan

Answer: B

Q9. Who wrote 'The Compleat Angler, or the Contemplative Man's Recreation'?

- A. Sir Thomas Browne
- B. Izaak Walton
- C. Thomas Fuller
- D. Richard Baxter

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Answer: B

Q10. Why has 'The Compleat Angler' been popular with countless readers who care nothing for fishing?

- A. Because of its complex political allegory
- B. On account of its pleasant gossipy style and genuine rustic flavour
- C. Because it is a violent tragedy
- D. Because it contains hidden scientific formulas

Answer: B

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Page 95 - Caroline Prose (Part 2) & History

Q1. Who occupies the first place in history writing of this period with his 'History of the Great Rebellion'?

- A. Thomas Hobbes
- B. Edward Hyde, Earl of Clarendon
- C. Izaak Walton
- D. Richard Baxter

Answer: B

Q2. Why is Clarendon's 'History of the Great Rebellion' considered untrustworthy?

- A. He made everything up
- B. By reason of its royalist bias
- C. Because he was a strict Puritan
- D. Because it was written 200 years later

Answer: B

Q3. Despite its bias, why is Clarendon's history justly admired?

- A. For its comedic value
- B. For its stately diction and its skilful studies of character
- C. Because it is extremely short
- D. Because it is written in blank verse

Answer: B

Q4. Who wrote 'Leviathan', the most important political treatise inspired by the unrest of the time?

- A. John Milton
- B. Thomas Hobbes
- C. Francis Bacon
- D. Edward Hyde

Answer: B

Q5. What does Thomas Hobbes advocate for in 'Leviathan'?

- A. Absolute anarchy
- B. Strong central government

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- C. A pure democracy
- D. The abolition of all government

Answer: B

Q6. Speaking generally of the prose writers of this time (including Milton), what is true of their style?

- A. It is exactly like modern conversational English
- B. We nowhere recognize in their style the characteristic tone and manner of our modern prose
- C. They all wrote entirely in rhymed couplets
- D. They refused to use punctuation

Answer: B

Q7. Which author's charming Essays have a great deal in common with the simpler and clearer way of writing that the Age of Dryden would soon introduce?

- A. Abraham Cowley
- B. John Milton
- C. Jeremy Taylor
- D. Thomas Hobbes

Answer: A

Q8. Where can the Table of the Literature of the Age of Milton be found in the book?

- A. Pages 1-5
- B. Pages 109-111
- C. Pages 76-78
- D. It is not in the book

Answer: B

Q9. According to the footnote, what is the origin of the term 'Caroline'?

- A. It comes from the French word for poetry
- B. From 'Carolus', Latin for Charles
- C. From Queen Caroline
- D. It means 'musical'

Answer: B

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Q10. Which era was about to introduce a simpler and clearer way of prose writing?

- A. The Age of Shakespeare
- B. The Age of Dryden
- C. The Age of Chaucer
- D. The Victorian Era

Answer: B

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Page 96 - The Age of Dryden

Q1. What period does 'The Age of Dryden' cover?

- A. 1558-1603
- B. 1603-1625
- C. 1625-1660
- D. 1660-1700

Answer: D

Q2. What event brought an immense change in the general temper of the English people, starting this new age?

- A. The defeat of the Spanish Armada
- B. The Stuart Restoration
- C. The signing of the Magna Carta
- D. The Black Death

Answer: B

Q3. The Stuart Restoration was followed by a sweeping reaction against what?

- A. The monarchy
- B. Puritanism and everything it had stood for
- C. Classicism
- D. The French

Answer: B

Q4. Because of this reaction, what was too often cast aside along with religious fanaticism?

- A. Art and literature
- B. Moderation and decency
- C. Education and science
- D. The English language

Answer: B

Q5. How does the author describe the court of Charles II?

- A. The most pious and devout in history

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- B. The most shameless this country has ever known
- C. A center of strict Puritanical law
- D. A perfect democracy

Answer: B

Q6. What became fashionable during the Age of Dryden?

- A. Strict moral virtue
- B. Infidelity and profligacy
- C. Going to church daily
- D. Refusing to wear jewelry

Answer: B

Q7. What happened to the moral ideals of Puritanism during this time?

- A. They were strictly enforced by law
- B. They were turned into jest, and those who upheld them were laughed at as hypocrites
- C. Everyone adopted them secretly
- D. They were completely forgotten without mention

Answer: B

Q8. Did this spirit of corruption remain only within the narrow circle of court and aristocracy?

- A. Yes, the rest of the country was unaffected
- B. No, the spirit of corruption spread far and wide, lowering the moral tone everywhere
- C. No, it only affected the poor
- D. Yes, the King kept it contained

Answer: B

Q9. What great principle of interpretation does this era perfectly illustrate?

- A. That literature has nothing to do with history
- B. That literature is a social product and inevitably reflects the life of the era out of which it springs
- C. That poetry is only written by good people
- D. That monarchs always write the best books

Answer: B

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Q10. Based on these social conditions, what can be anticipated about the literature of the Age of Dryden?

- A. It will be incredibly pure and religious
- B. It will reflect the corruption, profligacy, and reaction against Puritanism of the time
- C. It will focus only on nature
- D. It will ignore society entirely

Answer: B